

Three Automotive Occupations

NAME _____

DATE _____

PERIOD _____

One comparison basis

Salary = May 2024 U.S. national median annual wage. Outlook = 2024-34 U.S. projection. Openings = annual average over the projection period. These are not DFW starting salaries.

1. Automotive Service Technician or Mechanic

- Inspects, maintains, and repairs cars and light trucks; increasingly uses computerized diagnostic equipment.
- Common preparation: many complete a postsecondary automotive program; some enter with high school and learn on the job.
- Median: **\$49,670**
- Growth: **4%**
- Annual openings: **70,000**

Two daily-work facts:

1.

2.

One preparation fact and one limitation:

Source: U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, accessed August 2026.

2. Diesel Service Technician or Mechanic

- Diagnoses, adjusts, repairs, or overhauls buses, trucks, and diesel engines.
- Common preparation: high school plus on-the-job learning; employers may prefer postsecondary diesel training.
- Median: **\$60,640**
- Growth: **2%**
- Annual openings: **26,500**

One daily-work fact and one preparation fact:

3. Automotive Body and Related Repairer

- Repairs vehicle bodies and related structures after damage.
- Preparation may include high-school or postsecondary repair training and on-the-job skill development.
- Median: **\$51,680**
- Growth: **2% for the combined body and glass group**
- Annual openings: **16,000 for the combined body and glass group**

One daily-work fact:

Why the combined-group label must remain:

Sources: U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, accessed August 2026.

4. Compare all three

OCCUPATION	MEDIAN RANK, 1-3	COMMON PREPARATION	GROWTH	ANNUAL OPENINGS	ONE WORK/TASK DIFFERENCE
Automotive Service Technician					
Diesel Service Technician					
Automotive Body and Related Repairer					

Salary difference between the highest and lowest medians:

One preparation difference:

One reason salary alone cannot decide fit:

One limitation of using national evidence for a DFW student:

5. Recommend for fictional Taylor

Taylor enjoys diagnostics, wants paid work soon, and prefers electronic systems over painting or heavy equipment.
First occupation Taylor should investigate:

Table fact 1:

Table fact 2:

Why the facts fit Taylor's priorities:

One local question the national data cannot answer:

Authorized local or official source:
